MEASURE "Y" - SAN BERNARDINO COMMUNITY COLLEGE DISTRICT

FULL TEXT BALLOT PROPOSITION

SAN BERNARDINO COMMUNITY COLLEGE DISTRICT

BOND MEASURE ELECTION NOVEMBER 3, 2026

"Local College Affordability, Job Training, Repairs Measure. To maintain affordable college education access, by repairing /upgrading San Bernardino Valley College, Crafton Hills College; preparing students/ veterans for high-demand careers including skilled trades, firefighting, healthcare; providing safe drinking water; removing asbestos, mold; repairing deteriorating gas lines; acquiring, constructing, repairing facilities, sites, equipment; shall San Bernardino Community College District's measure authorizing $898,000,000 in bonds at legal rates, levying $25 per $100,000 of assessed valuation ($56,000,000 annually) while bonds are outstanding, requiring oversight, audits, be adopted?"

Bonds – Yes Bonds – No

PROJECTS

The Board of Trustees of the San Bernardino Community College District, to be responsive to the needs of its community, evaluated San Bernardino Valley College and Crafton Hills College's urgent and critical facility needs, and its capacity to provide **students,** and **Veterans** with support and **job training** facilities, an **affordable education** and prepare them for success in **college** and **careers** and **skilled trades. Job training** facilities, **safety** issues, class size and offerings, and information and computer technology were each considered in developing the types of projects to be funded by this measure.

In developing the scope of projects, basic repairs, **job training facilities,** campus safety, facilities supporting Veterans, and the expansion of opportunities for local students, including the mountain communities, to maintain access to a **local affordable higher education,** were **prioritized.** If these facility needs are not addressed now, the District's Colleges would be unable to remain competitive in preparing students for **high-demand jobs** and **careers** and university transfer.

The Board of Trustees determines that **San Bernardino Valley College and Crafton Hills College MUST:**

(i) Prepare students and veterans for careers in skilled trades;

(ii) Expanding workforce training for wildfire protection, snow removal, emergency response, teachers, nurses, and other local jobs in mountain communities;

(iii) Prepare students for high-demand jobs and careers that cannot be taken away by AI;

(iv) Repair deteriorating gas lines;

(v) Maintain local affordable higher education;

(vi) Adhere to stringent FISCAL ACCOUNTABILITY safeguards including:

(a) Public disclosure of all spending

(b) All expenditures will be subject to annual independent financial audits,

(c) No funds will be used for administrators' salaries and pensions,

(d) An independent citizens' oversight committee will be appointed to ensure that all funds are spent only as authorized.

The following types of projects are authorized to be undertaken at San Bernardino Valley College, Crafton Hills College and at District Sites and Facilities:

PROVIDE LOCAL STUDENTS AN AFFORDABLE EDUCATION:

Basic Improvements Needed To Allow San Bernardino Valley College and Crafton Hills College to provide

AFFORDABLE CAREER EDUCATION FACILITIES FOR FIREFIGHTERS AND SKILLED TRADES

Goals and Purposes: Wildfires are getting more extreme statewide, and we recently experienced both the Bridge and Line Fires which burned tens of thousands of acres. San Bernardino Community College District is responsible for training most of the firefighters, paramedics, and other emergency medical responders who protect our community. This measure is needed to train local firefighters to keep us safe during future emergencies.

This measure includes strict accountability requirements, including public disclosure of all spending, independent annual financial and performance audits, and a citizens' oversight committee to make sure all funds are used effectively, efficiently, and as authorized by voters. By law, all funds will be used for our local community colleges and cannot be taken by county, state or federal governments.

- Removing asbestos and mold.

- **Repairing deteriorating gas lines.**
- Upgrading emergency communications systems.
- Upgrading campus safety and security, including fire safety systems.
- **Providing safe drinking water.**
- Repairing and upgrading classrooms and labs.
- Repairing and upgrading air conditioning and heating systems.
- Earthquake retrofitting school buildings and classrooms.

PROVIDE LOCAL STUDENTS AND MOUNTAIN AREAS ACCESS TO AN AFFORDABLE EDUCATION IN A SAFE ENVIRONMENT:

Improvements Needed to Provide

LOCAL JOB TRAINING PROGRAMS THAT ARE NEEDED TO PREPARE STUDENTS FOR GOOD-PAYING CAREERS IN NURSING, TEACHING AND FIREFIGHTING

Goals and Purposes: This measure will allow residents in our mountain communities to save money on college, avoid traffic and expensive gas prices and receive an affordable local college education close to home. The measure will lead to access to affordable college education and job training closer to home, hiring of local residents for new jobs, and a better trained workforce in key fields such as nursing, teaching, and firefighting.

- Creating a community college center in the mountain area of the District.
- Upgrade classrooms and labs and career training facilities for **nursing, teaching, and firefighting.**
- Improve Student Centers to provide job training, job placement, counseling, and support services to students**.**

In addition to the projects listed above, at all District sites and facilities, repair, renovation and construction projects may include, but not be limited to, some or all of the following: replace, renovate, acquire and install emergency power generators, upgrade or construct student and staff restrooms, aging electrical and plumbing systems, campus wide infrastructure improvements, heating, ventilation and air conditioning systems; acquire vehicles; upgrade of facilities for energy efficiencies, including photovoltaic/solar installations, battery energy storage and electric vehicle charging stations; repair and replace worn-out and leaky roofs, windows, walls doors and drinking fountains/hydration stations; build new or renovate/expand existing facilities such as multi-use classrooms and labs, science buildings, veterans' support facility, administrative buildings, arts facilities, nursing and kinesiology facilities, career and technical education buildings, student services, gateways and welcome centers, bookstore, dining and food services, college storage and recycling facilities, swing space, outdoor classrooms/performance space, child development buildings, student services/campus center and instruction buildings, athletic fields and facilities, physical education facilities, fine arts and visual and performing arts facilities including theatres and galleries, classrooms, and buildings, bus stops, parking lots, structures, and garages; plan, construct, acquire or contribute to affordable student and workforce housing units; replace or remove outdated buildings and classrooms and construct new classrooms and support buildings; install wiring and electrical systems to safely accommodate computers, technology and other electrical devices and needs; upgrade facilities to meet current environmental sustainability and State compliance standards; repair and replace fire alarms, emergency communications and security systems; upgrade, resurface, replace, construct or relocate hard courts, fields, gymnasiums, turf and irrigation systems; install, replace, or repair scoreboards and turf on athletic fields; upgrade classrooms; build, renovate, upgrade, expand or repurpose facilities, including but not limited to, at San Bernardino Valley College, Career Pathways 1- Technical Building, Career Pathways 2, Student Services, Allied Health & Aeronautics Building, Welding Building, softback field, Administration Building, Campus and Community Resource Hub, Hospitality Hub (including community garden), Child Development Center and Parent Education Center, KVCR, Community Hub, Maintenance & Operations Building, Library, Creek Theatre and Planetarium, academic buildings, Health and Life Sciences Buildings, Lois Carson Campus Center. Police Department and Police Academy, athletic fields and facilities, warehouse, Campus Technology Services, Student Health Services, Central Plan, at Crafton Hills College, Public Safety Training Center, Performing Arts Center, Child Development Center, Allied Health Building, Student Support Building, West Complex, Crafton Center, instructional buildings, active learning classrooms, Learning Resource Center, gymnasium and tennis courts, soccer field, and central plan, and at District Support Operations, the Del Rosa campus and multi-Purpose building, Professional Development Center, Applied Technology Training Center, outdoor classrooms, District Office, KVCR, Campus Community Resource Hub, including the Police Department and printing services; upgrade, resurface and recondition existing parking lots, roads and sidewalks; repair, upgrade and install interior and exterior lighting systems; replace water lines and valves and sewer lines; repair, upgrade and install, utilities, hydronic systems, plumbing, gas lines, sewer, telecommunications, water distribution systems, and stormwater infrastructure; improve water conservation and energy efficiency; acquire or lease land; replace existing window systems with energy-efficient systems to reduce costs; improve insulation, weatherproofing and roofs to reduce costs; improve access for the disabled; install and repair fire safety equipment, including alarms, smoke detectors, sprinklers, emergency lighting, and fire safety doors; replace broken concrete walks, deteriorated asphalt; replace/upgrade/install signage to reflect better wayfinding, marquees, bells and clocks; modernize, construct, upgrade elevator systems; demolition of outdated or unsafe facilities; install or upgrade new security systems, such as security (surveillance) cameras, burglar alarms, handrails, outdoor lighting, fencing, landscaping, gates, gateways and classroom door locks; replace sewer lines and improve drainage systems to prevent flooding; upgrade roadway and pedestrian paths and pathways and bridges for improved safety and access for emergency vehicles; construct parking structures; improve surface

parking, utilities and grounds. The project list also includes the reduction, refinancing or retirement of outstanding lease obligations and interim funding incurred advance fund projects from the Project List, as well as the funding of an endowment for technology and other authorized projects.

The upgrading of technology infrastructure includes, but is not limited to, upgrading, expanding, and acquiring classroom technology, wireless internet access and networks, portable interface devices, servers, switches, routers, computers, modules, sound projection systems, district-wide computer lab upgrades, interactive boards, cameras, sound projection, information systems, printers, digital white boards, upgrade voice-over-IP, communication systems, enterprise software, licenses and warranties, audio/visual and telecommunications systems, call manager and network security/ firewall, Internet connectivity, wireless systems, technology infrastructure, disaster recovery and business continuity infrastructure (secondary sites, backup systems, redundant connectivity), information security systems, such as security monitoring and incident response infrastructure, including logging, SIEM/SOC tools, endpoint security, and data loss prevention and other miscellaneous IT and instructional equipment, DATA storage, fiber/ copper infrastructure, phones, identity access cards, the creation and upgrading of technology for distance learning, acquire necessary software and the construction and installation of on-premises, cloud-based, or hybrid data center and related infrastructure for District enterprise systems, such as resource planning, websites, domain name systems, cloud applications and information security.

The listed projects will be completed as needed. Each project is assumed to include its share of furniture, equipment, architectural, engineering, and similar planning costs, program/project management, staff training expenses, a customary contingency, and costs associated with the Total Cost of Ownership of facilities and equipment. In addition to the listed projects stated above, authorized projects also include the acquisition of a variety of instructional, maintenance and operational equipment, including interim funding incurred to advance fund projects from payment of the costs of preparation of all facility planning, fiscal reporting, facility studies, assessment reviews, facility master plan preparation and updates, environmental studies (including environmental investigation, remediation and monitoring), design and construction documentation, and temporary housing of dislocated college activities caused by construction projects, including leasing portable buildings and off-site parking. The allocation of bond proceeds may be affected by the final costs of each project. Some projects may be undertaken as joint use projects in cooperation with other local public agencies or non-profits. The budget for each project is an estimate and may be affected by factors beyond the District's control. The final cost of each project will be determined as plans and construction documents are finalized, construction bids are received, construction contracts are awarded and projects are completed. Based on the final costs of each project, certain of the projects described above may be delayed or may not be completed. Demolition of existing facilities and reconstruction of facilities scheduled for repair and upgrade may occur, if the Board determines that such an approach would be more cost-effective in creating more enhanced and operationally efficient campuses. In addition to the listed types of projects stated above, the types of authorized projects of the measure also include the acquisition of a variety of instructional, maintenance and operational equipment. Necessary site preparation/restoration, including the acquisition and installation of temporary facilities (swing space) may occur in connection with new construction, renovation or remodeling, or installation or removal of relocatable classrooms, including ingress and egress, removing, replacing, or installing irrigation, utility lines, trees and landscaping, relocating fire access roads, and acquiring any necessary easements, licenses, or rights of way to the property. Proceeds of the bonds may be used to pay or reimburse the District for the cost of District staff when performing work on or necessary and incidental to bond projects. Bond proceeds shall only be expended for the types of projects and purposes identified herein. The District shall create an account into which proceeds of the bonds shall be deposited and comply with the reporting requirements of Government Code Section 53410.

FISCAL ACCOUNTABILITY

This bond measure has strict accountability requirements including:

1. All money will benefit San Bernardino Valley College and Crafton Hills College campuses and CANNOT BE TAKEN BY THE STATE.

2. NO MONEY can be used for ADMINISTRATOR SALARIES or pensions.

3. Require CITIZENS' OVERSIGHT and yearly AUDITS to ensure all funds are used locally, effectively and as promised.

4. NO ADMINISTRATOR SALARIES. Proceeds from the sale of the bonds authorized by this proposition shall be used only for the acquisition, construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, including the furnishing and equipping of school facilities, and not for any other purpose, including teacher, faculty and college administrator salaries, pensions and other operating expenses.

5. **FISCAL ACCOUNTABILITY. THE EXPENDITURE OF BOND MONEY ON THESE PROJECTS IS SUBJECT TO STRINGENT FINANCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY REQUIREMENTS. BY LAW, PERFORMANCE AND FINANCIAL AUDITS WILL BE PERFORMED ANNUALLY, AND ALL BOND EXPENDITURES WILL BE MONITORED BY AN INDEPENDENT CITIZENS' OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE TO ENSURE THAT FUNDS ARE SPENT AS PROMISED AND SPECIFIED. THE CITIZENS' OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE MUST INCLUDE, AMONG OTHERS, REPRESENTATION OF A BONA FIDE TAXPAYERS ASSOCIATION, A BUSINESS ORGANIZATION AND A SENIOR CITIZENS ORGANIZATION. NO DISTRICT EMPLOYEES OR VENDORS ARE ALLOWED TO SERVE ON THE CITIZENS' OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE**.

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TAX RATE STATEMENT

An election will be held in the San Bernardino Community College District (the "District") on November 3, 2026 to authorize the sale of up to $898,000,000 in general obligation bonds. If such bonds are authorized and sold, principal and interest on the bonds will be payable only from the proceeds of *ad valorem* tax levies made upon the taxable property in the District. The following information is submitted in compliance with Section 9401 of the Elections Code of the State of California. Such information is based upon the best estimates and projections presently available from official sources, upon experience within the District, and other demonstrable factors.

The following information is provided pursuant to Elections Code Section 9401:

1. The best estimate of the average annual tax rate that would be required to be levied to fund this bond issue over the entire duration of the bond debt service, based on estimated assessed valuations available at the time of filing of this statement, is $25.00 per $100,000 (2.5¢ per $100) of assessed valuation. It is currently expected that the tax will be collected until fiscal year 2058-59.

2. The best estimate of the highest tax rate that would be required to be levied to fund this bond issue, for each year that bonds are outstanding, based on estimated assessed valuations available at the time of filing this statement, is $25.00 per $100,000 (2.5¢ per $100) of assessed valuation, which is projected to be the same in every fiscal year the bonds remain outstanding.

3. The best estimate of total debt service, including principal and interest, that would be required to be repaid if all the bonds are issued and sold will be approximately $1.9 billion.

Voters should note that these estimates are based on projections derived from information obtained from official sources, and are based on the assessed value (not market value) of taxable property on the County's official tax rolls. Property owners should consult their own property tax bills and tax advisors to determine their property's assessed value and any applicable tax exemptions.

The attention of all voters is directed to the fact that the foregoing information is based upon projections and estimates only, which amounts are not maximum amounts and durations and are not binding upon the District. The actual debt service, tax rates and the years in which they will apply may vary depending on the timing of bond sales, the par amount of bonds sold at each sale and actual increases in assessed valuations. The timing of the bond sales and the amount of bonds sold at any given time will be determined by the District based on the need for project funds and other considerations. Actual assessed valuations will depend upon the amount and value of taxable property within the District as determined by the County Assessor in the annual assessment and the equalization process.

Diana Z. Rodriguez, Ed.D.
Chancellor
San Bernardino Community College District

IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE "Y"

This Impartial Analysis of Bond Measure Y has been prepared by the County Counsel pursuant to Section 9313 of the California Elections Code.

This Measure was placed on the ballot by a resolution adopted by the Board of Trustees of the San Bernardino Community College District (District). A "yes" vote by at least fifty-five percent of the voters voting on this Measure will authorize the District to issue bonds in the amount of $898,000,000 to be used solely for the purposes set forth in this ballot Measure. A "no" vote means that the District will not be authorized to issue and sell the $898,000,000 in bonds set forth in the Measure.

The District's Resolution was adopted pursuant to California Education Code sections 15100 et seq. and 15264, et seq., Government Code section 53506, and Articles XIIIA and XVI of the California Constitution. The bond proceeds may only be used for specific projects at San Bernardino Valley College and Crafton Hills College listed in Exhibits "A" and "B" of the Measure (Projects). The identified Projects are the specific projects the District proposes to finance with proceeds from the sale of the bonds authorized by this ballot Measure and the bond proceeds may only be used for those specific projects. These projects include: affordable career education facilities for firefighters and skilled trades; local job training programs to prepare students for good-paying careers in nursing, teaching and firefighting; removing asbestos and mold; repairing deteriorating gas lines; upgrading emergency communications systems; upgrading campus safety and security, including fire safety systems; providing safe drinking water; repairing and upgrading classrooms and labs; repairing and upgrading air conditioning and heating systems; earthquake retrofitting school buildings and classrooms; creating a community college center in the mountain area of the District; upgrading classrooms and labs and career training facilities for nursing, teaching, and firefighting; improving student centers to provide job training, job placement, counseling, and support services to students; and other repair, renovation and construction projects.

The District will conduct financial and performance audits annually and all bond expenditures will be monitored by an independent Citizens' Oversight Committee, in compliance with Education Code section 15278 et seq., that will receive and review annual audits, inspect District facilities, receive copies of maintenance plans, and review efforts to implement cost-saving programs. No District employees or vendors will be allowed to serve on the Citizens' Oversight Committee.

The bonded debt will be a general obligation of the District and will be financed by taxes levied annually on taxable property located within the District.

By: LAURA FEINGOLD,
County Counsel

s/ JOLENA E. GRIDER,
Deputy County Counsel

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE "Y"

Our region faces economic challenges. **San Bernardino Community College District is part of the solution to this crisis, but it needs our help. That's why we need YES on Y!**

Public universities like UC's and CSU's cost six to sixteen times more than San Bernardino Valley College or Crafton Hills College. **YES on Y keeps local college and career training affordable so students can transfer or learn hands -on job skills, without debt.**

YES on Y trains our students locally for high- skilled, good- paying jobs. Skilled tradespeople, teachers, firefighters and more are in high demand. YES on Y upgrades and expands local job training programs so local students can learn marketable skills and build careers right here, without using expensive gas or time, to commute hours away.

YES on Y keeps our local college campuses safe and ready to serve local students. Many local community college classrooms are over 100 years old and are deteriorating. Funding will help remove asbestos and mold; repair outdated sewer, electrical and gas lines; and upgrade pipes to keep drinking water safe. Specialized training classes and labs are outdated. **YES on Y** fixes these dangers now, so students are safe and college programs can train the workers we need.

Wildfires are getting more extreme— the Bridge and Line Fires alone burned tens of thousands of acres. We need more trained firefighters, paramedics, emergency first responders and nurses. **YES on Y** keeps specialized classrooms/ labs for our local colleges' **nursing, firefighting, and emergency training programs up to date** and expanding, so help is there when we need it most.

YES on Y is accountable — requiring public spending disclosure, audits and citizen oversight. No money can be taken from our community.

Join firefighters, nurses, and local small businesses to keep college affordable and our community working and safe. YES ON Y!

Learn more: AffordableCollegeAndCareer.com

By: Yolanda Simental, RN
San Bernardino County nurse

Rich Sessler,
Local fire chief

Judy D. White, Ed.D.,
Small business owner

Don Averill, Ed.D.,
Citizens oversight committeemember

Richard Jaramillo,
Skilled trades graduate

NO ARGUMENT FILED AGAINST MEASURE "Y"